COROUTE · **OPERATORS & PARTNERS**

Ride Organiser SOP: Group Ride

Standard operating procedure for operators, ride leads and sweepers running a group ride on CoRoute.

Version: CoRoute 3.56 · November 2026 · Owner: [OWNER TO FILL: operator's safety lead]

> This SOP describes how to use CoRoute's built features on a group ride. It does not replace road law, your own risk assessment, first-aid training or the emergency services. **In a life-threatening emergency, call 112 first.**

1. Roles

Role	Who	Responsibilities
Operator / base	Owner or co-organiser, at a laptop with the console	Starts the ride, invites the roster, watches the live map, opens the emergency contact during an SOS, and coordinates with family or authorities.
Lead (L)	Experienced rider on your roster. Trip owner in the app.	Sets the route and group settings, sets the pace, picks regroup and break points, ends the ride. Gets the spread and incident alerts.
Sweeper (S)	Experienced rider at the back	Rides at the back and never overtakes the last rider. Gets the "behind the sweeper" and "no reply" alerts. Stops with any rider who stops.
Pack	All other riders	Keep their place, use quick replies, follow the briefing.

Optional, for larger groups: **buddy pairs**. CoRoute pairs riders automatically once a ride reaches 7 riders. The lead can reassign pairs in **Group settings > Buddy pairs**.

2. Pre-ride briefing checklist

Do this at the meeting point, 20 to 30 minutes before the start. A printable one-page version is in *safety_briefing_template.md*.

2.1 Riders and bikes

- ☐ Licence, registration, insurance and PUC papers carried (as your policy requires).
- ☐ Bike check (T-CLOCS style):
  - tyres (pressure, tread, cuts);
  - brakes front and rear;
  - chain slack and lube;
  - lights, indicators and horn;
  - mirrors;
  - fuel level against the first fuel stop;
  - no fluid leaks.
- ☐ Riding gear: certified helmet (strap fastened), gloves, jacket, boots, rain gear if forecast.
- ☐ Phone in a **handlebar mount**, charged or on a charger. CoRoute warns once per ride if the phone seems to be in a pocket or loose, because crash detection works best when mounted.

2.2 In the CoRoute app (every rider)

☐ Signed in, and has **accepted the ride invite** (or joined with the code).

☐ **Emergency contact** set in the profile.

☐ **Medical info** filled in: blood group, allergies, notes for a doctor. It shows on the lock screen and goes to the people helping only during an open SOS or crash alert.

☐ **Pre-ride phone check** run. It tests GPS, sensors, SOS readiness and battery in under a minute.

☐ Location, notifications, motion and microphone permissions allowed. The microphone is used for the intercom and siren alerts.

☐ Optional: a **guardian**, a family member who follows the ride live and gets "Arrived safely".

☐ Bike details filled in, or "I'm riding pillion".

2.3 Roles and plan

☐ Introduce the lead and the sweeper by name, and check that the app shows them (**L** and **S** on the map).

☐ Route, planned stops, **regroup points** and fuel stops explained.

☐ Hand signals and the overtaking rule agreed (no overtaking the lead, none inside the group on ghats).

☐ Riding formation (staggered) and the distance between riders agreed.

2.4 Group settings (lead's phone, Group settings)

☐ **Group speed limit**: Off, 40, 60, 80, 100 or 120 km/h. Riding over it for 10 seconds is logged and the group is told once.

☐ **Group spread alert (km)**: 1, 2, 3 or 5 (default 3). The lead hears "Group spread 4 kilometers, slow down" when the group stretches too far.

☐ Buddy pairs checked (7+ riders).

2.5 Communication

☐ **Intercom**: hold to talk to the whole group or to the leads. Test it once at the meeting point.

☐ **Ride chat quick actions**: one-tap tiles **Fuel, Break, Wait for me, I'm OK, Slow down, Regroup here, On my way, Arrived**. Typing works only when stopped. While moving, only the quick replies work.

☐ Agree that nobody handles the phone while moving. Cards that need a tap show their buttons only when stopped.

2.6 Emergency briefing (say it out loud)

☐ "If you crash, your phone counts down 30 seconds. Tap **I'm OK** if you are fine. If you do not answer, the SOS goes out by itself."

☐ "To raise an SOS yourself, **hold the SOS button for 1.5 seconds**."

☐ "The SOS reaches the group, the lead and sweeper, and your emergency contact by text with a live link."

☐ "If someone is hurt: make the scene safe, **call 112**, do not move the injured rider unless there is danger, and do not remove a helmet unless trained."

☐ Location of the first-aid kit, and who has first-aid training.

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3. During the ride

3.1 Normal running

- The **lead** holds the agreed pace and watches for the **group spread** card. When it shows:
  - slow down;

    - or use **Set regroup point**. CoRoute suggests a fuel, food or rest place 2 to 10 km ahead of the last rider.
- The **sweeper** stays at the back. CoRoute alerts the sweeper and the lead when a rider drops behind the sweeper.
- **Missing-rider check**:
    - If a rider has been stopped for about 3 minutes while the group rides on, their phone asks "Are you OK? The group is moving on".
    - The rider can answer **I'm OK**, **Need help**, **Waiting for fuel**, **Photo stop** or **Taking a break**, or hold **Send SOS**.
    - If there is no answer in 90 seconds, the lead and sweeper get "No reply from <name>".
- **Roll call**: the ride sheet shows "Joined / Not yet" at the start and "Arrived / On the way" at the destination.
- **Base** keeps the live map open. The card of each ride shows riders, speed and last update.

3.2 Fuel and breaks

- Riders tap **Fuel** or **Break** in the chat quick actions so that the group knows why they stopped.
- **Break reminders**:
    - every rider gets a break reminder after 2 hours, then every hour;
    - it may come earlier if their phone sees signs of fatigue (time of day, wobble, micro-stops).
- **Group break planner**: when several riders are getting tired, the lead sees "Several riders need a break. Plan a stop?" with a suggested place. It never names who is tired.
- Plan fuel against the **smallest tank** in the group, not the lead's.

3.3 Sirens and road hazards

- **Emergency vehicle siren**:
    - CoRoute listens with the phone's own microphone during rides and says "Emergency vehicle siren close by. Keep left and give way.";
    - music pauses for the alert;
    - **Everyone keeps left and gives way.** The lead does not stop the group in the carriageway.
- **Road hazards**:
    - potholes and speed breakers felt by the rider at the front warn the riders behind;
    - stretches where many riders brake hard trigger "Many riders brake hard on this stretch. Ride carefully.";
    - the pack slows down and keeps its spacing.
- **Low battery**: below 10% CoRoute switches to an SOS battery saver, and the group is told if a phone shuts down. The lead should plan a charging stop.

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4. Emergency procedure: SOS or crash alarm

4.1 What raises an alert

- a rider holds **SOS** (1.5 s), or holds **Send SOS** on the missing-rider card;
- **crash detection**: 30-second countdown with "I'm OK" / "Need Help", then the SOS goes out by itself;
- **"Bike down?"**: the bike falls while stopped or at walking pace and does not move for a minute, which opens the same 30-second countdown.

When the SOS goes out:

- the group, the lead and the sweeper get the alert. The SOS alarm sound can break through Do Not Disturb where the phone allows it;
- the rider's emergency contact gets a text with a live link. The rider's phone sends it through the messages app if the internet is down. If CoRoute has server SMS turned on, the server can also send it;
- the operator console shows the red banner.

4.2 Who does what

Step	Lead	Sweeper	Operator / base
1	Stop the group safely off the road. Do not stop in a blind bend.	If behind the rider, stop and secure the scene first (hazard lights, warn traffic).	Read the banner: rider, ride, time. Open **Emergency contact**.
2	Send the nearest one or two riders back (or the sweeper). Not the whole group.	Check the rider: conscious? breathing? bleeding?	**Call 112** if the riders on scene have not, and give the last position from the dialog.
3	Open the incident card in the app: **nearest hospital** with Navigate, and the live emergency link for the lead.	**Call 112** (or 108 for an ambulance) from the incident screen. Give the location: the live link or coordinates.	Call the **emergency contact** (from the dialog) when appropriate, calm and factual.
4	Keep the rest of the group together and off the road.	Do not move the rider unless there is danger. Do not remove the helmet unless trained. Keep them warm.	Share the **live link** with family or responders if needed. Note the times.
5	When help arrives: decide whether the ride continues, and set new roles (**Roles** in the console, or in the app).	Stay with the rider, or hand over to the support vehicle.	Watch the other rides on the map. Keep a written incident log.
6	The rider, or someone helping, closes the SOS ("Help reached me" / "False alarm").		The emergency contact view closes automatically when the SOS is resolved.

4.3 Notes

- **Call 112 first** in any life-threatening situation. CoRoute does not call emergency services for you. The SMS text itself tells the contact "Call 112".
- **Riders from other groups nearby** may be asked to help when the rider needs it. Accepted responders see the first name, bike, medical info and emergency contact while the alert is open.
- **No signal**: the SOS is kept on the phone and sent as soon as there is a connection. Nearby CoRoute phones can relay it over the phone-to-phone link.
- **False alarm**: the rider taps **I'm OK** during the countdown. If the SOS has already gone out, the rider closes it with **False alarm**, and the contact gets a "safe now" text (when server SMS is on).
- **Privacy**: open the emergency contact only for that SOS. Each view is recorded. Do not copy medical info anywhere else.

5. After the ride

- ☐ **Arrival roll call**: confirm "Everyone has arrived" in the app. Guardians get "Arrived safely".
- ☐ The lead ends the ride in the app, or base presses **End** in the console.
- ☐ Check **Attendance**: any rider marked **Left early**? Confirm they are safe.

☐ Review the **incidents** for the ride (type, time, outcome) and complete your own incident report. CoRoute reports contain no locations.
☐ Export the CSV if your records need it (if it is in your plan). Store it securely, and delete it when you no longer need it.
☐ Debrief the lead and sweeper: what worked, near misses, route changes for next time.
☐ Send a **broadcast** with thanks and the next ride (no prices, offers, phone numbers or e-mail).

6. Records to keep (suggested)

Record	Where	Keep for
Signed rider consent / waiver	Your own files	[OWNER / LEGAL TO FILL]
Briefing sign-off	Your own files	[OWNER / LEGAL TO FILL]
Incident log (times, actions, calls made)	Your own files	[OWNER / LEGAL TO FILL]
Attendance CSV	Exported from the console	Only as long as needed